

95. Drone-Matrix: Courier Dispatch

DSA Final Project

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Abstract

Drone-Matrix is a C++-based airspace simulation and drone dispatch management system designed to model large-scale urban drone delivery operations. The system manages package dispatch, route planning, battery-aware drone allocation, congestion handling, emergency flight rollback, charging pad allocation, and real-time fleet tracking.

The project applies core Data Structures and Algorithms including Graphs, Dijkstra's Algorithm, Queues, Stacks, HashMaps, Priority Queues, Merge Sort, and Quick Sort to solve real-world logistics problems. A React-based visualization layer is additionally developed to demonstrate simulation states and operational workflows during project presentation.

Problem Statement (95. Courier Dispatch Airspace Drone Matrix)

A delivery company operates hundreds of drones across a city. Every day, thousands of packages must be delivered while avoiding restricted airspace zones, battery failures, congestion, and weather disruptions.

The system must:

- Enforce airspace restrictions
- Support emergency flight rollback
- Process package dispatch in FIFO order
- Resolve customer addresses rapidly
- Allocate drones efficiently
- Calculate optimal routes
- Manage charging pad assignments
- Track drone movement in real time

Objectives

Primary Objectives

- Build a drone dispatch simulation engine.
- Implement shortest-path route planning.
- Prevent restricted airspace violations.
- Track battery consumption and charging.
- Manage congestion and rerouting.
- Support emergency recovery mechanisms.

Secondary Objectives

- Visualize fleet activity.
 - Demonstrate real-time simulation ticks.
 - Present route progression and mission status.
 - Provide an educational demonstration of DSA concepts.
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Technology Stack

Backend

- C++
- STL Containers
- Object-Oriented Programming

Frontend Visualization

- React.js
- Vite
- SVG Graphics
- CSS

Data Storage

- Text Configuration Files
-

System Architecture

Data Files

↓

Manager Layer

↓

Services Layer

↓

Simulation Engine

↓

CLI Interface

↓

React Visualization Layer

Core Modules

Airspace Manager

Maintains nodes, corridors, traffic counts, and restricted zones.

Drone Manager

Maintains fleet information and drone allocation logic.

Package Manager

Maintains FIFO dispatch queue.

Flight Manager

Maintains rollback checkpoints.

Mission Manager

Tracks delivery missions and lifecycle states.

Pad Manager

Allocates charging pads and manages occupancy.

Route Service

Computes shortest routes and battery costs.

Address Service

Performs address-to-node mapping.

Simulator

Coordinates the complete simulation lifecycle.

Data Structures Used

Graph

Purpose:

Represents city airspace.

Implementation:

Adjacency List

Applications:

- Route Planning
 - Restricted Zone Avoidance
 - Congestion Handling
-

Queue

Purpose:

Package Dispatch

Implementation:

FIFO Queue

Operations:

- Enqueue Package
- Dequeue Package

Complexity:

$O(1)$

Stack

Purpose:
Flight Undo System

Implementation:
FlightState Stack

Operations:

- Push Checkpoint
- Pop Checkpoint

Complexity:
 $O(1)$

HashMap

Purpose:
Address Lookup

Implementation:
unordered_map

Operations:

- Coordinate Lookup
- Node Lookup

Complexity:
 $O(1)$ Average

Algorithms Used

Dijkstra Algorithm

Purpose:

Shortest Route Generation

Why Used:

Airspace corridors contain weighted edges representing travel cost.

Complexity:

$O((V + E) \log V)$

Merge Sort

Purpose:

Fleet Battery Sorting

Complexity:

$O(N \log N)$

Quick Sort

Purpose:

Alternative Fleet Sorting

Complexity:

Average $O(N \log N)$

Requirement Implementation

Airspace Rules

Restricted nodes are excluded during route generation.

Flight Undo

Flight checkpoints are stored using stacks and restored during emergencies.

Launch Line

Packages are dispatched using FIFO queue processing.

Address Lookup

Order IDs are mapped to coordinates using HashMaps.

Drone Sorter

Available drones are ranked according to battery margins.

Best Flight Path

Dijkstra computes optimal routes while avoiding restricted areas and congested corridors.

Pad Manager

The nearest available charging pad is selected using shortest-path calculations.

Simulation Engine

Mission States

ACTIVE

RETURNING

EMERGENCY

BLOCKED

DELIVERED

ARCHIVED

Battery Safety Model

Required Energy =

Pickup Cost

+

Delivery Cost

+

Safe Exit Cost

Safe Exit Cost =

$\min(\text{Return Cost}, \text{Pad Cost})$

Only drones with positive energy margin may be dispatched.

Congestion Management

Corridors contain:

- Capacity
- Current Traffic

When capacity is reached:

- Drone waits
- Reroute attempted
- Deadlock detection triggered

After 3 wait ticks:

- Forced reroute
 - BLOCKED state if reroute fails
-

React Visualization Layer

Purpose:

Presentation and demonstration.

Features:

- Airspace Map
- Fleet Dashboard
- Package Queue
- Mission Panel
- Event Log
- Simulation Controls

Note:

The React application does not execute simulation logic. The authoritative implementation remains the C++ simulation engine.

[No-Fly Restricted Zones]: Node 11 (Restricted_Hospital) Node 4 (Restricted_Airport)

[Simulator Logs]:

* Simulator initialized successfully.

=====

COURIER DISPATCH AIRSPACE DRONE MATRIX
(Simulation Tick: 0)

=====

Fleet Size: 5 Drones | Warehouses: 1 | Charging Pads: 3 | Restricted Zones: 2 | Active Packages: 0

=====

Active Flights: None

=====

1. Airspace Overview
 2. Fleet Dashboard
 3. Package Queue
 4. Address Lookup Demo
 5. Dispatch Delivery
 6. Advance One Tick
 7. Advance Five Ticks
 8. Trigger Storm
 9. Undo Flight
 10. Charging Pad Dashboard
 11. Run Full Demonstration
 12. Exit
- =====

Enter choice (1-12):

=====

LIVE FLEET STATUS

=====

Active Missions: 0

Archived Missions: 0

=====

Drone: 105

Current Node: 0 (Warehouse_Alpha)

Battery Remaining: 30

Status: IDLE

=====

Drone: 104

Current Node: 2 (East_Corridor_1)

Battery Remaining: 86

Status: IDLE

=====

Drone: 103

Current Node: Pad 3

Battery Remaining: 7

Status: IDLE

=====

Drone: 102

Current Node: 0 (Warehouse_Alpha)

Battery Remaining: 85

Status: IDLE

=====

Drone: 101

Current Node: 1 (North_Corridor_1)

Battery Remaining: 94

Status: IDLE

=====

Choose Fleet Reporting Sort:

1. None (Default order)
2. Merge Sort (Descending Battery)
3. Quick Sort (Descending Battery)

Enter sub-choice (1-3):

```
=====
TICK 1
=====
```

```
Drone 103
Charging at Pad 3
Battery: 7 -> 22
Status: CHARGING
=====
```

```
Traffic Integrity Check: PASSED
- No flight corridors exceeded capacity.
- No negative traffic counts detected.
- Reserve/Release lifecycle fully valid.
```

```
=====
LIVE FLEET STATUS
=====
```

```
Active Missions: 0
Archived Missions: 0
=====
```

```
Drone: 105
Current Node: 0 (Warehouse_Alpha)
Battery Remaining: 30
Status: IDLE
=====
```

```
Drone: 104
Current Node: 2 (East_Corridor_1)
Battery Remaining: 86
Status: IDLE
=====
```

```
Drone: 103
Current Node: Pad 3
Battery Remaining: 22
Status: CHARGING
=====
```

```
Drone: 102
Current Node: 0 (Warehouse_Alpha)
Battery Remaining: 85
Status: IDLE
=====
```

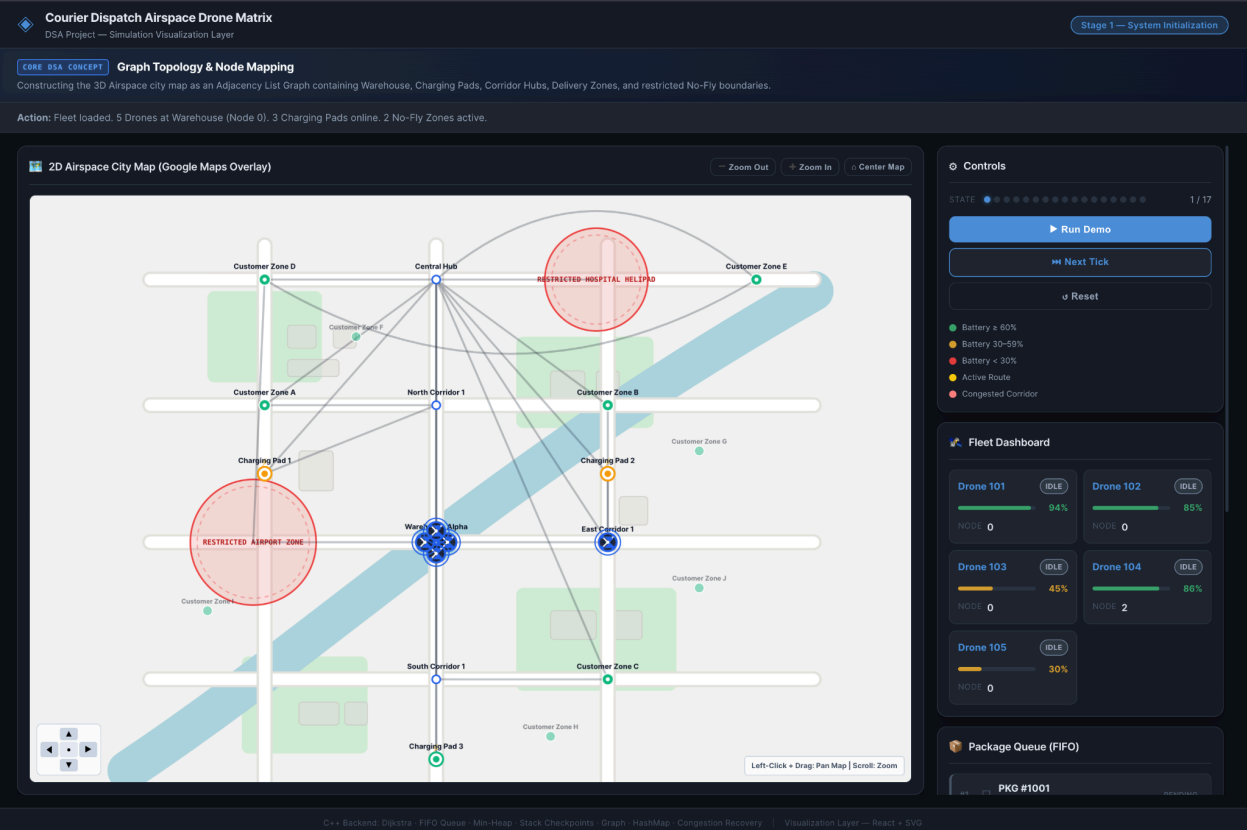
```
Drone: 101
Current Node: 1 (North_Corridor_1)
Battery Remaining: 94
Status: IDLE
=====
```

```
=====
STAGE 1: SYSTEM INITIALIZATION
=====
```

```
[INFO] Loading static configurations and dynamic assets...
```

```
* Fleet Status:      5 Active Drones (ID: 101, 102, 103, 104, 105)
* Dispatch Depot:    1 Central Warehouse (Warehouse_Alpha at Node 0)
* Charging Network:   3 Smart Charging Pads (Pad 1, Pad 2, Pad 3)
* Airspace Restrictions: 2 No-Fly Zones (Restricted_Airport, Restricted_Hospital)
```

```
[Verification]: System initialization successful. All resources loaded.
=====
```



Future Enhancements

- 3D Airspace Engine
 - Real GPS Coordinates
 - Live Weather Integration
 - Real Drone Telemetry
 - WebSocket Communication
 - Database Persistence
 - Multi-City Support
 - AI-Based Route Prediction
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Conclusion

Drone-Matrix successfully demonstrates the practical application of Data Structures and Algorithms in solving large-scale drone logistics problems. The system integrates Graphs, Queues, Stacks, HashMaps, Priority Queues, and shortest-path algorithms to manage routing, congestion, battery safety, emergency recovery, and charging operations. The project meets all major problem-statement requirements while providing a scalable architecture suitable for future expansion.

References

1. C++ STL Documentation
 2. Dijkstra Shortest Path Algorithm
 3. React Documentation
 4. Vite Documentation
 5. Graph Theory References
 6. Operating Principles of Autonomous Drone Networks
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GitHub Repository

Repository Link: <https://github.com/Samarth-ITM/Drone-Matrix>

Demonstration Link

Visualization URL: <https://drone-matrix.vercel.app/>